

3.2.3 Sport psychology

In this section students will develop knowledge and understanding of the role of sport psychology in optimising performance in physical activity and sport.

Students should be able to understand and interpret graphical representations associated with sport psychology theories.

3.2.3.1 Psychological factors that can influence an individual in physical activities

3.2.3.1.1 Aspects of personality

Content	Additional information
Understanding of the nature vs nurture debate in the development of personality.	Trait, social learning.
Interactionist perspective.	Hollander, Lewin.

Content	Additional information
How knowledge of interactionist perspective can improve performance.	

3.2.3.1.2 Attitudes

Content	Additional information
Triadic model.	Components of an attitude. Formation of attitudes. Changing attitudes through cognitive dissonance and persuasive communication.

3.2.3.1.3 Arousal

Content	Additional information
Theories of arousal.	Drive theory, inverted U theory, catastrophe theory and zone of optimal functioning theory.
Practical applications of theories of arousal and their impact on performance.	
Characteristics of peak flow experience.	

3.2.3.1.4 Anxiety

Content	Additional information
Types of anxiety.	Somatic, cognitive, competitive trait and competitive state.
Advantages and disadvantages of using observations, questionnaires and physiological measures to measure anxiety.	

3.2.3.1.5 Aggression

Content	Additional information
Difference between aggression and assertive behaviour.	
Theories of aggression.	Instinct theory, frustration-aggression hypothesis, social learning theory and aggressive cue theory.
Strategies to control aggression.	

3.2.3.1.6 Motivation

Content	Additional information
Motivation.	Intrinsic, extrinsic, tangible and intangible.

3.2.3.1.7 Achievement motivation theory

Content	Additional information
Atkinson's Model of achievement motivation.	
Characteristics of personality components of achievement motivation.	Need to achieve (Nach) and Need to avoid failure (Naf).
Impact of situational component of achievement motivation.	Incentive value and probability of success.
Achievement goal theory.	Impact of outcome orientated goals and task orientated goals.
Strategies to develop approach behaviours leading to improvements in performance.	

3.2.3.1.8 Social facilitation

Content	Additional information
Social facilitation and inhibition.	Zajonc's model.
Evaluation apprehension.	
Strategies to eliminate the adverse effects of social facilitation and social inhibition.	

3.2.3.1.9 Group dynamics

Students should understand how group dynamics can influence the performance of an individual and/or team.

Content	Additional information
Group formation.	Tuckman's model.
Cohesion.	Task and social.
Steiner's model of potential and actual productivity, faulty group processes.	Including cooperation and coordination.
Ringelmann effect and social loafing.	

Content	Additional information
Strategies to improve cohesion, group productivity and overcome social loafing to enhance team performance.	

3.2.3.1.10 Importance of goal setting

Content	Additional information
Benefits of types of goal setting.	Outcome goals, performance related goals, process goals.
Principles of effective goal setting.	SMARTER (specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, time bound, evaluate, re-do).

3.2.3.1.11 Attribution theory

Content	Additional information
Attribution process.	
Weiner's Model and its application to sporting situations.	
Link between attribution, task persistence and motivation.	
Self-serving bias.	
Attribution retraining.	
Learned helplessness.	General and specific.
Strategies to avoid learned helplessness leading to improvements in performance.	

3.2.3.1.12 Self-efficacy and confidence

Content	Additional information
Characteristics of self-efficacy, self-confidence and self-esteem.	
Bandura's Model of self-efficacy.	Performance accomplishments, vicarious experiences, verbal persuasion and emotional arousal.

Content	Additional information
Vealey's Model of self-confidence.	Relationship between trait sport confidence, competitive orientation, the sport situation and state sport confidence.
Effects of home field advantage.	
Strategies to develop high levels of self-efficacy leading to improvements in performance.	

3.2.3.1.13 Leadership

Content	Additional information
Characteristics of effective leaders.	
Styles of leadership.	Autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire.
Leadership styles for different sporting situations.	
Prescribed and emergent leaders.	
Theories of leadership in different sporting situations.	Fiedler's contingency theory and Chelladurai's multi-dimensional model.

3.2.3.1.14 Stress management

Content	Additional information
Explanation of the terms 'stress' and 'stressor'.	
Use of warm up for stress management.	
Effects of cognitive and somatic techniques on the performer.	
Explanation of cognitive techniques.	Mental rehearsal. Visualisation. Imagery. Attentional control and cue utilisation. Thought stopping. Positive self-talk.
Explanation of somatic techniques.	Biofeedback, centering, breathing control, progressive muscle relaxation.